

HALL OF SHAME

Yeddyurappa is not alone to make an early exit. Here's a list.

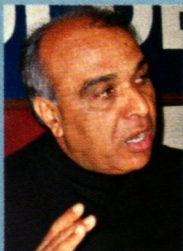
JAGADAMBIKA PAL: (Uttar Pradesh)
2 DAYS. Feb 21-23, 1998.

JANAKI RAMACHANDRAN: (Tamil Nadu) 23 DAYS. Jan 7-30, 1988.

K. KARUNAKARAN: (Kerala)
14 DAYS. April 11-25, 1977.

SHIBU SOREN: (Jharkhand)
10 DAYS. March 2-12, 2005.

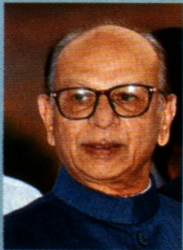
O.P. CHAUTALA: (Haryana)
5 DAYS. July 12-17, 1990.



JAGADAMBIKA PAL



O.P. CHAUTALA



PRATAP SINGH RANE



NITISH KUMAR

PRATAP SINGH RANE: (Goa)
1 DAY. June 7-8, 2005.

NITISH KUMAR: (Bihar)
7 DAYS. March 3-10, 2000.

BHUMIDHAR BARMAN: (Assam)
23 DAYS. April 22-May 15, 1996.

N. BHASKARA RAO: (Andhra Pradesh) 30 DAYS.
Aug 16-Sept 16, 1984.

BHOLA PASWAN SHASTRI: (Bihar)
12 DAYS. June 22-July 4, 1969.

B.B. LYNGDOH: (Meghalaya)
30 DAYS. March 2-April 2, 1983.



BRIGHTER SIDE: The BJP leadership that was exuberant on making its power debut in the south now hopes to cash in on the sympathy factor.

role to play in the famous S.R. Bommai judgement that is referred to every time a state governor toys with the idea of imposing Central rule. Bommai won a key contest to become the chief minister of Karnataka but it is said Gowda did not like the idea of a Bommai enjoying the top position. He used his good offices with the then home minister Buta Singh to prevail upon the then governor to dismiss the government. Some of the JD(s) legislators went to the governor saying their signatures were forged but the governor did not pay heed. The fight led to the famous S.R. Bommai judgement which is applicable in the current political drama. Governor Rameshwar Thakur, in this case, was forced to invite both the parties on the basis of their support letters to form a government although his initial hunch was that there would be no stability and hence it would be better to go in for Central rule.

When Gowda resigned from the chief minister's post in 1996 to take over as the country's prime minister, he promised that he would finalise the name of his successor in Bangalore within 24 hours, recalls an old associate. Much against his wishes, it was

a Hegde associate, J.H. Patel who was chosen as the chief minister. Dejected that he could not have his man for the job, Gowda then had just one mission—make Patel's life in office miserable. That explains why, in his 11 months as prime minister, he flew to Bangalore no less than 20 times even for such mundane occasions like the inauguration of a new wedding hall, prompting one newspaper to refer to him as the prime minister of Karnataka. JD(s) leaders P.G.R. Sindhia and M.P. Prakash have similar tales to tell of the clan. Prakash in fact was left with egg on his face after he was sent to Delhi to talk to the Congress even as the father and son were secretly hobnobbing with BJP.

Amidst all the chicanery, what is forgotten is the state of India's third fastest growing state. Its success has been in spite of its politicians, not because of them. With elections now certain, all that Kannadigas hope for is for a stable government, whoever comes to power. Going by the events of the last week and the antics of the Gowdas, it's certain it will not be Karnataka's self anointed First Family.

As the prime minister Gowda flew to Bangalore at least 20 times. He once even inaugurated a wedding hall.